

Getting Started with Passport Seva

Summary of the Getting Started page of the Passport Seva portal

Source

Page: <https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/GettingStarted>

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About this document: a plain-language summary written from the pages above. It is not a verbatim copy and not an official publication. The site's content belongs to the Ministry of External Affairs, Government of India; always confirm details on the official site before acting.

The Getting Started page is the site's advisory for first-time visitors who plan to apply for a passport or a related service. It has twelve short sections, summarised here in the same order.

1. Why you need a passport

Every Indian citizen who leaves India, or intends to, must hold a valid passport or travel document. Under the Passports Act 1967 the Government of India can issue an Ordinary Passport, Diplomatic Passport, Official Passport, Emergency Certificate or Certificate of Identity.

2. Basic requirements of an application

An application needs the completed form, all prescribed documents and the fee. Submitting it is a request, not a right to a passport. It can be rejected for missing or deficient documents, for not following the procedure, or for any other reason. The basic supporting documents are:

- Proof of date of birth, such as a birth certificate
- Photo identity proof, which PSK officials verify from the address proof and other documents
- Proof of residence
- Proof of nationality, which PSK officials verify from the supporting documents

The page points to the site's Quick Guides and FAQs for more.

3. Who issues passports

- In India: the MEA, through the Central Passport Organisation (CPO) and its Passport Offices, Passport Seva Kendras (PSK) and Post Office Passport Seva Kendras (POPSK).
- Passports are issued through **37 Passport Offices**, the CPV Division (Diplomatic and Official passports only) and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands Administration.
- The network is extended by **93 PSKs** and **450+ POPSKs**.
- Abroad: **208 Indian Missions and Posts** provide passport and miscellaneous services.

Apply from anywhere in India

- You may check which Passport Office, PSK and POPSK cover your address before applying.
- You are not tied to that jurisdiction. You can choose any Passport Office, and any PSK or POPSK under it, whatever your present address.
- Police verification still happens at the address given in the form.
- The Passport Office you chose prints and dispatches the passport.

4. Procedures

Passport Seva introduced new procedures aimed at comfort for citizens, better delivery, transparency and stronger security. Applicants now have to appear in person at the PSK or POPSK, so that the Passport Issuing Authority can take their photograph and biometrics and decide the application in their presence.

5. Online registration and appointment

Appointments exist to avoid crowding at PSKs and POPSKs and to cut waiting time. Slots are allotted according to each centre's handling capacity, using an Electronic Queue Management System.

1. Register online
2. Fill in and submit the online application form
3. Schedule an appointment
4. Visit the PSK or POPSK

The page refers to the "Appointment Booking Process" quick guide for detail, and gives a direct login address: <https://services1.passportindia.gov.in/forms/PreLogin>

6. Online fee payment

- Online payment is compulsory to book an appointment at a PSK or POPSK.
- Accepted modes: credit or debit card (MasterCard, Visa, RuPay), internet banking (State Bank of India and associate banks only) and UPI.
- Tatkaal applicants pay the entire applicable fee online.
- Tatkaal is not currently available at a POPSK.
- A payment stays valid for **one year from the first appointment date**. If the application is not submitted at a PSK or POPSK in that time, the fee is forfeited.
- No refund, return or exchange of fee is entertained for passport-related services. Where several payments were made against the same ARN, refund claims are handled under the policy in force.

7. Cancelling or rescheduling a visit

If you cannot keep a confirmed appointment, reschedule or cancel it. This is allowed up to **two times** within a year of the first appointment date.

The site's application pages give a different limit: three reschedules, or one for Tatkaal. Check what the portal allows when you book.

8. Visiting the PSK or POPSK

- Bring the required original documents and photocopies. The list is on the website.
- You do not need to bring a photograph.
- If you had an appointment but were refused a token because documents were missing, you can return to the same PSK or POPSK.
- PSK facilities listed: helpful executives, self-service kiosks, photocopying, ATM, food and beverages, baby care, and an air-conditioned waiting hall.
- Applications are handled first in, first out through the Electronic Queue Management System.

9. Say no to touts

Avoid touts and agents who promise urgent appointments or faster delivery. The Government has not authorised any intermediary to do this or to give such assurances. Report such cases to the Regional Passport Office concerned.

10. Applicants' general obligations

- Give correct information and submit valid, genuine documents.
- Giving false information or holding back material information to obtain a passport or travel document is punishable under the Passports Act, 1967 with up to **two years' imprisonment**, a fine of up to **Rs. 5,000**, or both.
- Not allowed inside a PSK or POPSK: corrosive substances, explosives, arms, cudgels, sticks or lathis, and any sharp object that could cause harm.
- Also not allowed: electronic devices such as laptops, iPads and cameras.

11. Tracking your application

- A National Call Centre works in **23 Indian languages**, round the clock, seven days a week, for service information and application updates. Number shown on the site: **1800-258-1800**.
- There is also an e-mail helpdesk and the "Passport Seva" mobile app.

12. Contact

The MEA invites questions, feedback, suggestions and grievances. Feedback and suggestions can also be given at any Passport Seva Kendra. Online route:

<https://www.passportindia.gov.in/psp/RegisterFeedbackGrievance>